Arun Bagavathiannan

(979) 575-3148 | Email | LinkedIn | GitHub | Portfolio

Education

The University of Texas at Austin — Austin, TX
Bachelor of Science, Computer Science — *Expected Fall 2028*

Experience

Technical Lead, UT Registration Plus — Jan. 2026 – Present
Longhorn Developers

- Promoted from Software Engineer to Technical Lead in Aug. 2026; lead a team of 5 developers on a Chrome extension serving 60,000+ students
- Introduced an agile workflow (weekly standups, Linear milestones) and enforced CI gates on every PR (Biome, Storybook, Chromatic, CodeQL), cutting median PR open-to-merge time by 63%
- Ran end-to-end hiring for the developer fellowship: screened 80+ applicants, interviewed finalists, and selected 4 engineers (~5% acceptance)
- Built a real-time Course Status Checker and a throttled refresh system in React and TypeScript that avoids university API rate limits; cited in UT CS News coverage
- Authored Longhorn Developers' engineering standards guide, adopted by 54 developers across 11 project teams

Content Creator — Jul. 2021 – Jul. 2025
YouTube

- Grew channel to 20K+ subscribers and 7M+ views with consistent video editing tutorials
- Built a 26K-member Discord community with moderation practices and video editing contests

ML Research Intern — Dec. 2024 – Mar. 2025
Texas A&M University

- Presented results at 3 conferences, including WSSA (Vancouver) and EWRS (Spain)
- Trained a production-ready YOLOv8 model from 100+ raw images to 80%+ precision and recall
- Automated data augmentation with Python and OpenCV, scaling training data 6x (100 to 600+ images)

Projects

Breakout — Sep. 2026 – Present

- Identified that YouTube creators lack a fast way to spot breakout videos in their niche; built and launched a Chrome extension that surfaces outlier videos from channel metrics
- Designed a local TF-IDF niche filter that builds a weighted vocabulary from seed channels, surfacing adjacent outliers that keyword search misses

Perchside — Oct. 2026 – Present

- Built and published a Chrome extension (Manifest V3, TypeScript, React, WXT) that adds a floating productivity panel to claude.ai: themes, saved prompts, reminders, and a usage-limit timer
- Designed a freemium model and launched publicly on the Chrome Web Store; running distribution through Reddit and short-form video

Immigration Roadmap — Mar. 2026

- Built an AI tool for personalized immigration pathways; 1st Place at the AI Data Portability Hackathon

Skills

Programming: Python, C, C++, TypeScript, JavaScript, CSS, HTML, Java
Tools/Platforms: Chrome Extension (Manifest V3), WXT, React, Node.js, Git/GitHub, Vite, Linear, pnpm
AI/ML: MCP Integration, LLM Inference, RAG Pipelines, Model Training/Validation, Claude API
Product: Marketing, A/B Testing, Storytelling, Monetization, Roadmapping, Community Building, Technical Writing

Awards

International Education Fee Scholarship (IEFS) Recipient — Mar. 2026
Friends of Alec Engineering Scholarship Recipient — Feb. 2026